



The Toll Bridge

A refined culinary destination on the Kent riverside

Introduction

Repositioning a Legacy

Transforming a casual smokehouse into Kent's premier chef-led dining destination

— a strategic marketing approach for The Toll Bridge Restaurant & Bars.



The Brand Evolution

Former Identity

Casual smokehouse dining with traditional pub fare and relaxed atmosphere

New Positioning

Refined, chef-led dining destination offering Michelin-level culinary excellence

Premium Pricing

£35–£110 per head, positioning amongst Kent's finest dining establishments



Strategic Objective

Establish credibility as a fine
dining destination — quickly

Our Unique Strengths



Culinary Credibility

Michelin-experienced team led by Head Chef Shane Hughes, capable of delivering world-class gastronomy



Unrivalled Location

Scenic riverside setting with no direct competitor — a genuine destination advantage in Kent



Versatile Spaces

Intimate bars and private rooms ideal for weddings, celebrations, and corporate events

The Challenge

Perception Gap

Public still associates venue with old smokehouse identity rather than refined dining proposition

Digital Disconnect

Online presence not yet reflecting premium standards consistently across platforms

Price Resistance

Moving from casual to premium pricing creates friction with price-sensitive former customers

Destination Barrier

Sandwich location requires establishing venue as worth the journey for discerning diners

Market Opportunities

1

Culinary Enthusiasts

30-mile radius audience actively seeking chef-led experiences

2

Destination Dining

Gap in market for riverside alternative to established venues

3

Events Market

Growing demand for intimate weddings and private dining experiences



Competitive Landscape

The Competition

24 similar restaurants across Kent, including:

- The Fordwich Arms
- The Sportsman
- Tallow

All offering tasting menus, gift vouchers, signature dishes

Our Advantage

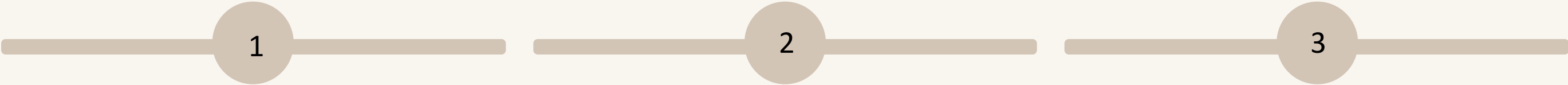
Michelin-starred experience — exceptional team with proven credentials

Historic riverside setting — unmatched views and relaxed elegance

Unique positioning — combining culinary excellence with scenic beauty



Target Audiences



1

Culinary Enthusiasts

Age: 35–60 | **Income:** £70,000+

Actively seeking Michelin-level dining,
engaging with chef-led content, willing
to travel for exceptional experiences

2

Occasion Diners

Age: 30–55 | Couples & celebrators

Seeking memorable, intimate
experiences for anniversaries,
proposals, special milestones

3

Local High-End Diners

Age: 30–65 | Sandwich residents

Value community connection, reliability,
convenience of premium local option

Strategic Objectives

Primary Goal

By September 2026, position The Toll Bridge firmly within Kent's premium dining category, increasing visibility, desirability, and long-term demand

Revenue Growth

Increase average order value towards
£35–£110 bracket

Event Revenue

Boost high-margin private hire and
wedding enquiries

Perception Shift

Reframe legacy identity to "elegant
dining destination"

Audience Transition

Retain loyal customers whilst attracting
premium diners



Three-Campaign Strategy



Campaign 1

Digital Presence

Events & culinary enthusiasts through
SEO, content marketing, visual
storytelling



Campaign 2

Cook with Shane Hughes

Exclusive chef-led events, earned media,
theatrical dining experiences



Campaign 3

Your Memories, Elevated

Local nostalgia marketing, reimagined
classics, community reconnection

Tactic and Action

Campaign 1

Digital Presence & Event Marketing

Repositioning through visual storytelling, SEO excellence, and strategic partnerships to capture events, weddings, and corporate bookings



Campaign Objectives

Primary:

- Increase event enquiries by X percent (Depending on the baseline data)
- Achieve 15 qualified bookings

Secondary:

- Improve rankings for event keywords
- Raise engagement on event content by 50 percent

Visual Repositioning

Event Focus

- Styled table setups
- Bridal arrangements
- Corporate settings
- Riverside celebrations
- Champagne moments

Food Focus

- Michelin-style plating
- Chef's technique shots
- Searing & finishing
- Macro dish details
- Plating sequences

Venue Focus

- Intimate atmosphere
- Guests enjoying food
- Community feeling
- Daily bustle
- Riverside beauty

Content Deliverables



- 50 edited professional photographs
- Cinematic website header video loop

- 2 hero reel videos + event montages
- Event brochures & corporate pitch decks



Experience-Led Storytelling

Content Focus

- Chef's journey & techniques
- Event transformations
- Seasonal inspiration
- Guest moments capture

Key Moments

- First toast & celebrations
- Riverside couple shots
- Family connections
- Slow-motion elegance

Formats: Reels, photo stories, carousel tours, TikTok-style transitions



SEO Strategy

Content Funnel

Top: Educational awareness content |
Middle: Consideration guides | **Bottom:**
Conversion-focused booking content

Publishing Plan

2 wedding blogs monthly, 1 corporate event
feature, 1 seasonal culinary story — all
keyword-optimised

Off-Page SEO

Backlinks from Hitched, Bridebook, wedding
photographers, local news outlets, event
directories



Partnership Ecosystem

Monthly Tasting Evenings

Curated Michelin-inspired experiences for wedding planners, corporate managers, photographers, influencers, high-value local clients

Guest Experience Touches

Personalised place cards, tableside plating, chef meet-and-greets, signature cocktails — moments designed for organic social sharing

Strategic Partnerships

Wedding Planners

25 Kent Wedding Planners

- Event brochure distribution
- Private tasting tours
- Commission per booking
- Co-branded content kits

Photographers

3 top Kent professionals

- Styled shoot access
- Portfolio usage rights
- Social media tagging
- Collaborative content

Corporate Clients

HR teams, organisers

- B2B pitch deck
- Corporate tasting events
- Dining packages
- Ongoing partnerships

Website Optimisation

Premium homepage hero video

Showcasing chef craft, riverside ambience, celebration moments

Refined chef section

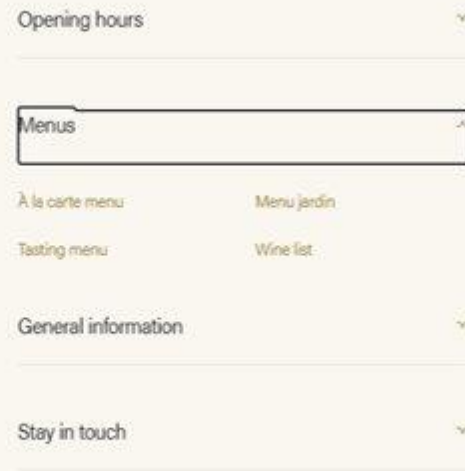
Precision shots highlighting culinary artistry and technique

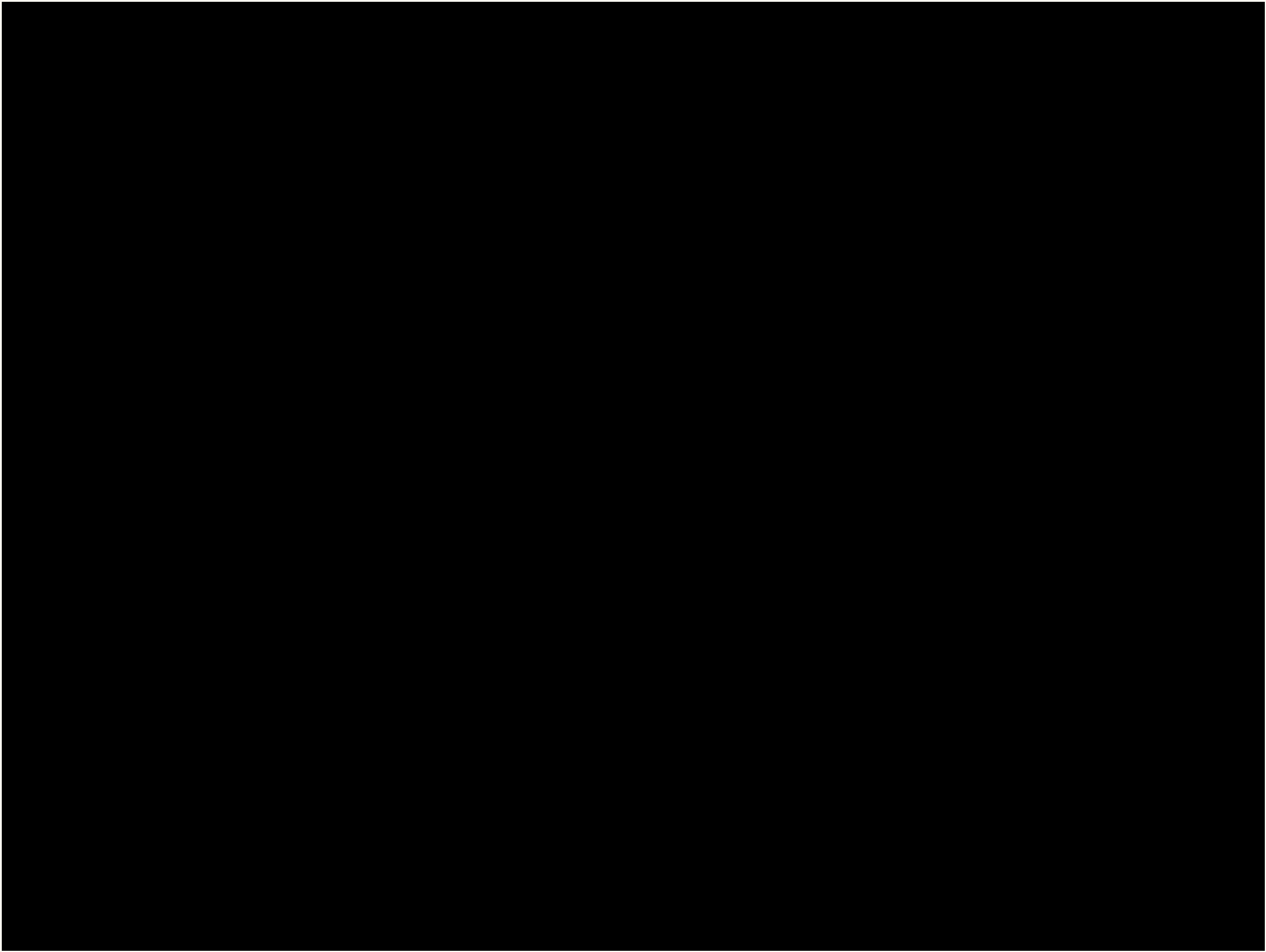
Clear navigation tiles

Key offerings prominently featured for improved user journey

Newsletter sign-up

"Premium dining and Michelin-level experiences for every occasion"







Website Optimisation



Premium Gift Experiences at The Toll Bridges

Give the gift of unforgettable dining, Whether you're celebrating a birthday, marking a milestone, or simply treating someone special, The Toll Bridges offers beautifully crafted dining experiences that make every occasion extraordinary.



Gift a Birthday Meal Deal From only £40

Celebrate someone's special day with a personalized birthday meal experience.



Gift an Achievement to a Friend

Perfect for graduations, promotions, new jobs, and personal wins.



Gift a Wedding Dinner to Newlywed Couples

Treat newlyweds to a beautiful dinner at The Toll Bridges.



Gift Yourself a Meal Treat

Enjoy a premium dining experience at The Toll Bridges.

Gift Page Strategy

Gift Options

- Birthday meal experiences from £40
- Achievement celebrations
- Wedding dinner gifts
- Self-indulgence treats

Creating a premium gift page expands revenue streams whilst positioning The Toll Bridge as a thoughtful, prestigious gifting option for special occasions

HOW GIFTING WORKS

- 1 Choose your experience
- 2 Select your amount or package
- 3 Personalise

Email Marketing Strategy

Lead Magnets

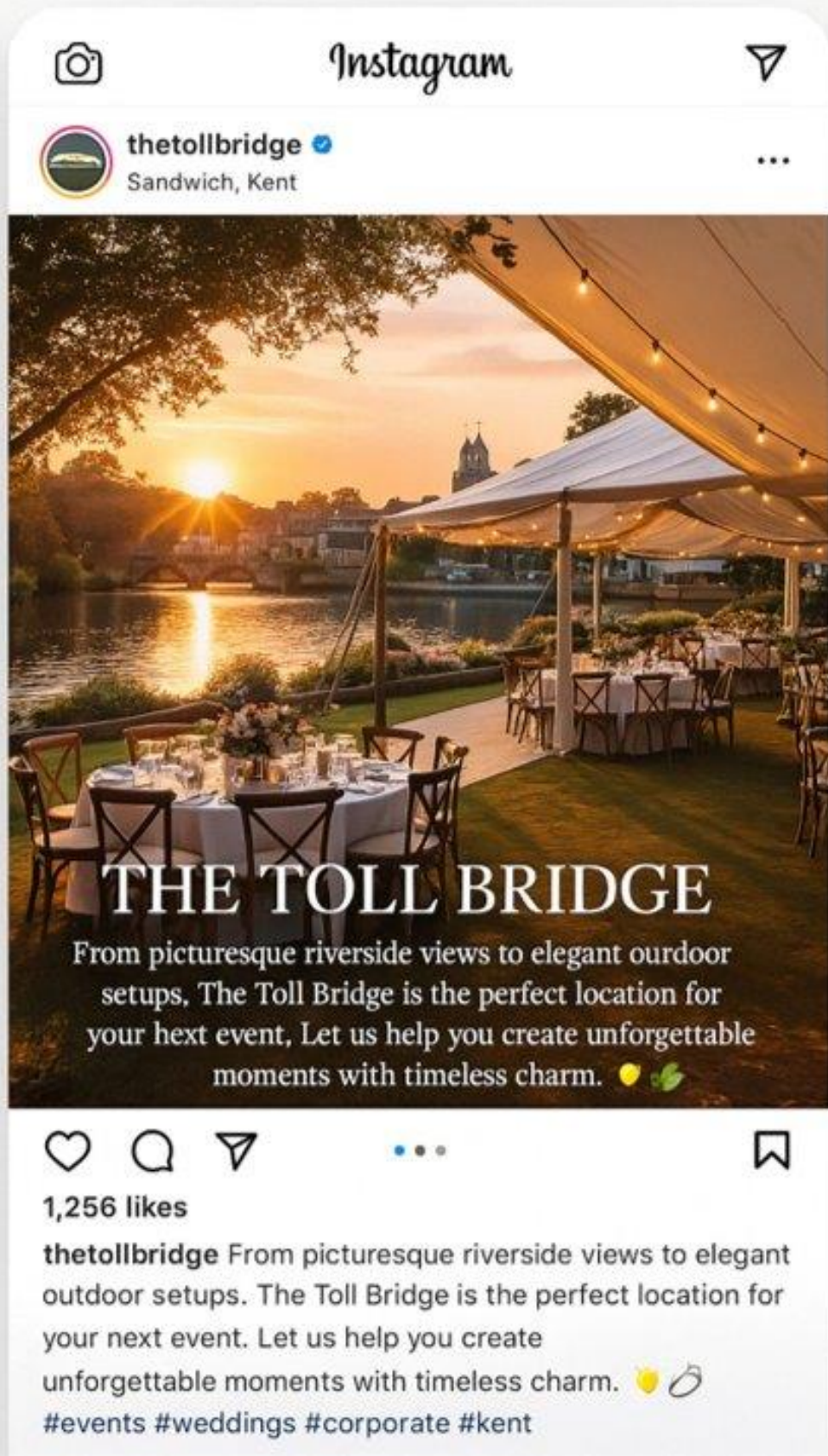
Event brochure downloads, sample menus, seasonal tasting invites, "Plan your event" quiz

Acquisition Channels

Homepage pop-ups, event landing pages, paid ads, social stories, footer sign-ups

Build First-Party Data

Capture qualified leads for nurture campaigns and remarketing



Social Media Calendar

Week 1

Venue teasers,
chef videos,
wedding setups,
CTA reels

Week 2

Behind-scenes
shoots, corporate
setups, story polls

Week 3

Guest moments,
testimonials,
menu features,
brochure CTAs

Week 4

Transformation
videos, seasonal
content, venue
walkthroughs

Paid Advertising Strategy

Platform	Stage	Strategy	KPI	Outcome
Meta (Facebook, Instagram)	Awareness + Consideration	3 adsets: Culinary Enthusiasts, Weddings, Local High-End	CTR, ER, video views, landing page visits	Shift perception, grow remarketing pools
Google Search	Conversions	Brand, competitor, RLSA campaigns	Conversions, cost per conversion, CTR	Capture high-intent bookings
Google DSA	Consideration	Dynamic longtail search capture	Clicks, time on page, conversions	Expand reach, capture missed queries
YouTube (Optional)	Awareness	Shorts, in-stream bumper ads	Video views, view rate, CTR	Build premium brand recall

Campaign 3 Timeline



Success Metrics

1

Event Enquiries

Track total high intent enquiries submitted via the website and social channels gauging perception shift.

2

Brochure Downloads

Monitor downloads of the wedding, corporate and celebrations brochures

3

Organic Keyword Positions

Track ranking improvements for wedding and corporate event intent terms using SemRush and Ahrefs.

4

Social Engagement

Analyze saves, shares, comments and DM enquiries on event content.

Target: >20% increase in ER

5

Ad Performance

Monitor cost per enquiry, click-through rates and conversion from event ads.



Campaign 2

Cook & Dine with Shane Hughes

An exclusive hands-on culinary masterclass

Establishing chef credibility whilst testing viability of premium ticketed experiences

Objectives

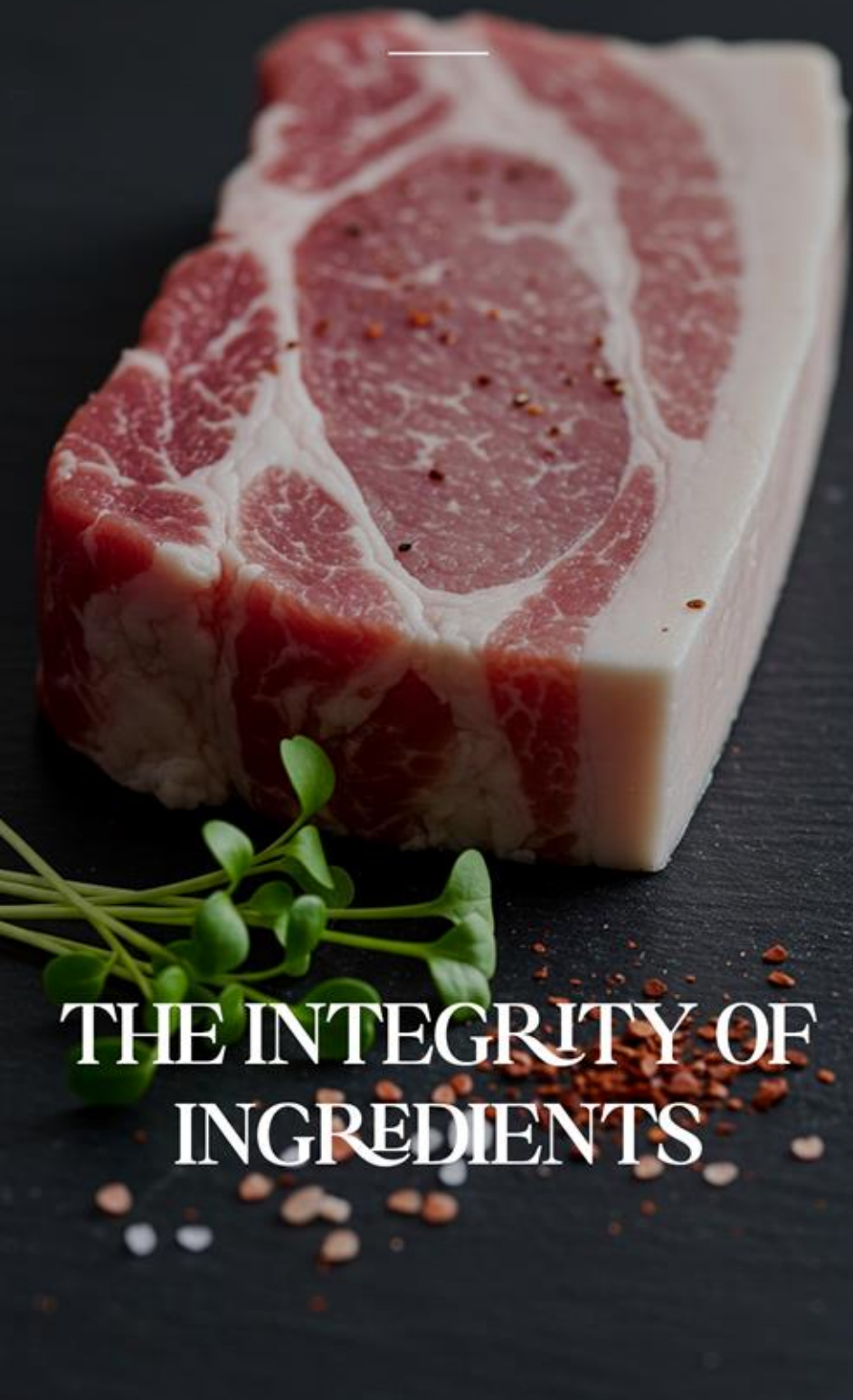
Primary-

Establish The Toll Bridge as a credible destination for Michelin-level gastronomy by leveraging Head Chef Shane Hughes's authority.

Secondary- (Revenue/ Testing)

Successfully test the viability of a high-margin, ticketed experience concept.

*Seasonal ingredients, classic technique. Taste
the care that goes into every dish.*



THE INTEGRITY OF INGREDIENTS

**An intimate cooking experience & menu tasting hosted by
Head Chef Shane Hughes, where invited Chef/Event/Food
Influencers & bloggers can:**

1

Learn how Toll Bridge signature dishes are created.

2

Watch behind the scenes demonstrations

3

Taste the full menu in stages

4

Talk and Q+A with Shane, learn about his inspiration, flavours, sourcing...

(if successful could lead to a ticketed event that becomes a unique experience none of the 24 similar restaurants in the area are offering)

Market Differentiation

Competitor: Updown
Farmhouse

£70 ticketed events featuring external
guest chefs cooking curated menus

The Toll Bridge Advantage

Hands-on interactive format with our
own Head Chef Shane Hughes —
unique in local high-end market



The Experience



Welcome & Drinks

Riverside arrival, champagne reception, host introduction to rebrand story



Hands-On Masterclass

Small stations: plate artistry, garnish creation, dessert piping practice



Live Demonstrations

Shane demonstrates signature dishes, explains artistry, reveals ingredient sourcing secrets



Multi-Course Tasting

5–7 courses, premium wines, kitchen stories, full Toll Bridge experience



Q&A + Exclusive Offers

Direct chef engagement, priority bookings, event hire discounts within 30 days

Post event scenes

An example reel created post event utilising UGC and high-quality content captured from the event. Enables restaurant story-telling and effective ways to share visuals from this intimate event.



Shane Hughes' interview

Build awareness

Deliver background information of upcoming event

Source of material for UGC media



Content post event

Prior to the event

Influencer Collaboration

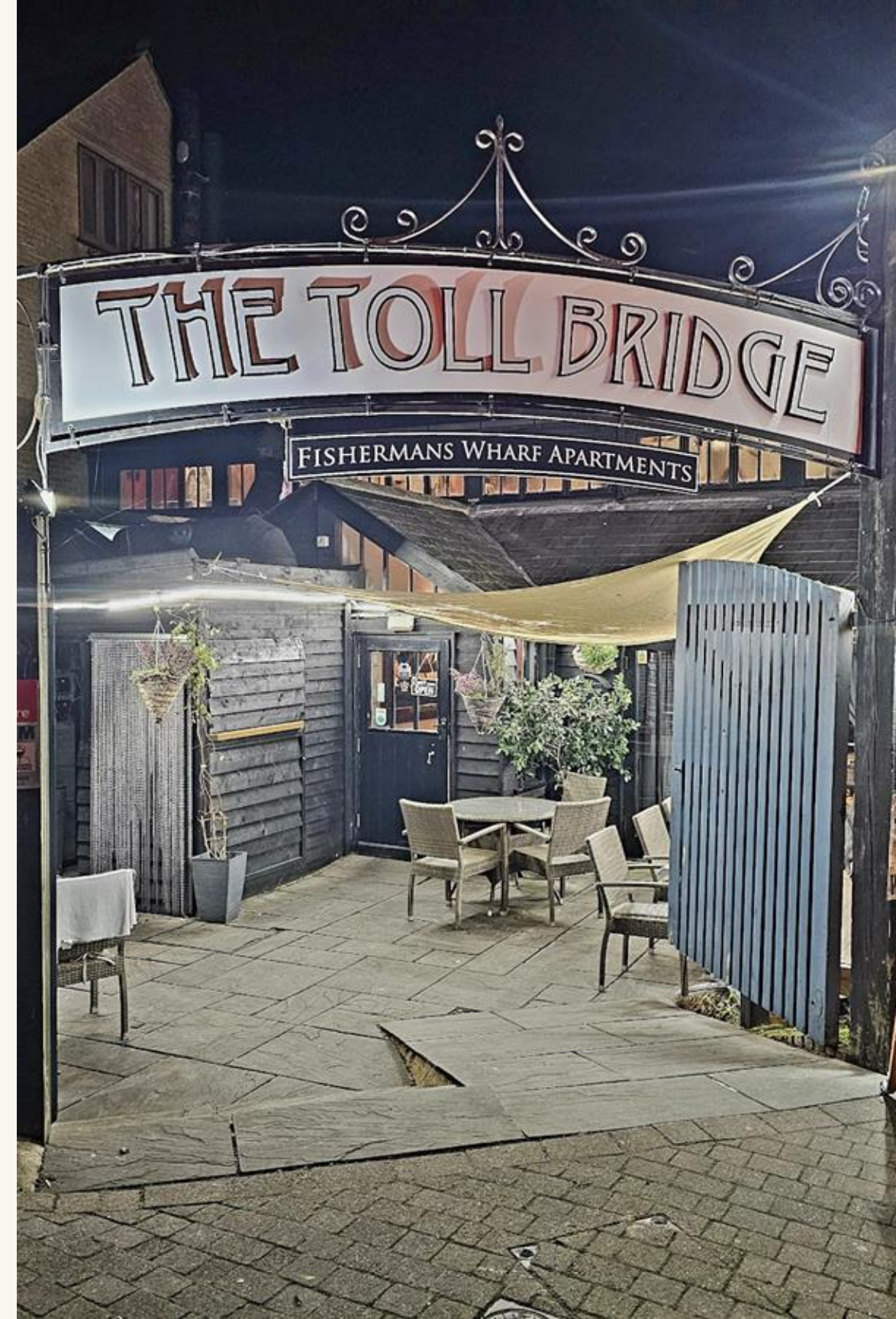
Identified Influencers

- [@boopfoodie](#)
- [@eatingwithtod](#)
- [@whatgeorgiaeats](#)

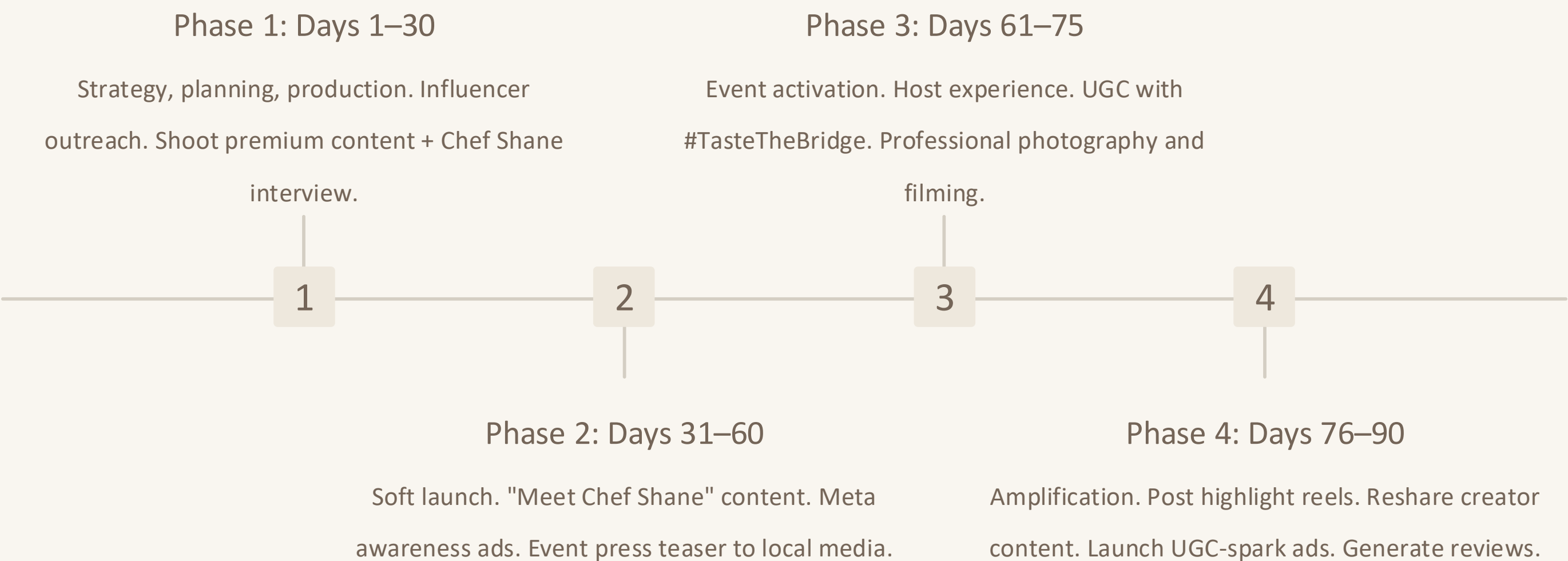
12–15 Kent food/lifestyle/chef influencers + 4–6 wedding/event bloggers

Audience Alignment

£70,000+ income bracket,
actively engaging with
Michelin-affiliated
restaurants, high
engagement on reels



Campaign Timeline



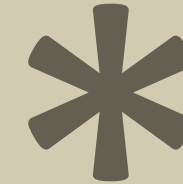
**POV : YOU TRAVELED ALL
THE WAY TO SANDWICH IN
KENT TO TRY THIS VIRAL
DESSERT**

Location: The Toll Bridge

Date night
📍 @TheTollBridge
tonight!

absolutely delicious meal made by
@chefshanehughes

EarnedMedia- Plating



Aesthetic looking practices
increases engagement and
engages interaction

Creative Content



Success KPI Metrics

1

Earned Media Count

Evaluate increased brand awareness and social insights

- Social media reach and impression
- Brand search volume from GA
- Website traffic

2

Growth in social engagement

- Engagement rate and hashtag usage
- Amount of UGC Content

3

Customer behaviour insights

- Reservation increase or decrease
- Return rate
- Review rating, volume and sentiment
- referral traffic from earned media



Campaign 3

Your Memories, Elevated

Honouring the past whilst celebrating the future — reconnecting with local diners through nostalgia marketing



The Local Strategy

"We aren't erasing the past; we are honouring it."

The Challenge

Locals value community and reliability. Risk of alienation if rebrand feels "cold" or "for tourists only"

The Solution

Acknowledge old favourites — present new versions as the dishes the chef always dreamed of creating



Activation Tactics

1

"Taste the Heritage" Event

Locals try set menu of reimagined classics — special dishes displayed on website, social media, cooking videos + testimonials

2

Direct Mail Campaign

Premium card-stock invitations delivered door-to-door to immediate residential catchment — feels personal and exclusive

3

Local Tasting Club

Email marketing to previous booking leads with code SANDWICH_ORIGINS for complimentary champagne

4

Content Marketing

Dish transformation videos, participant testimonials, Facebook Community Tab engagement, Instagram reels

Heritage Menu Reimagined



Old: BBQ Pulled Pork Bun → **New:** Orchard Pork & Crackling — slow-confited pork belly, pressed apple terrine, burnt onion purée, cider-vinegar gel

Old: Sticky Ribs → **New:** 48-Hour Short Rib — Kentish beef braised in local stout, bone-marrow crumb, pomme purée, heritage carrot glaze

Old: Loaded Fries → **New:** Potato & Truffle — triple-cooked potato pavé, shaved black truffle, parmesan foam

Personalised invitation for Taste the Heritage menu launch event

JOIN US AS WE HONOUR OUR HERITAGE

TASTE THE HERITAGE
YOUR MEMORIES,
ELEVATED



Kindly RSVP by December 10, 2025, to ensure your exclusive experience with us.

NOVEMBER 25, 2025
7:00 PM

THE TOLL BRIDGE, 7 FISHERMANS
WARE, SANDWICH, KENT, CT13 9RU



PERSONALISED INVITATION
TASTE THE HERITAGE
A PRIVATE EVENING FOR OUR VALUED PAST GUESTS

DEAR [NAME],
YOU'VE BEEN PART OF THE TOLL BRIDGE'S STORY — FROM FAMILY DINNERS TO CELEBRATIONS BY THE RIVERSIDE. YOUR MEMORIES SHAPED WHO WE ARE. WE WOULD BE HONOURED TO WELCOME YOU BACK FOR SOMETHING TRULY SPECIAL.

TASTE THE HERITAGE
EXCLUSIVE PREVIEW EVENING
AN INTIMATE NIGHT WHERE WE HONOUR OUR PAST AND UNVEIL OUR ELEVATED NEW DINING EXPERIENCE.

YOU WILL ENJOY:

- A REIMAGINED TASTING MENU INSPIRED BY CLASSIC DISHES LOVED BY LONG-STANDING GUESTS
- STORYTELLING FROM OUR CULINARY TEAM — THE INSPIRATION BEHIND EACH PLATE
- A GUIDED TOUR OF OUR NEWLY REFINED FINE-DINING SPACE
- A FIRST LOOK AT HOW WE ARE PRESERVING OUR HERITAGE WHILE ELEVATING EVERY DETAIL

EVENT DETAILS
LOCATION: THE TOLL BRIDGE, SANDWICH
DATE: [INSERT DATE]
TIME: [INSERT TIME]
CAPACITY: INVITATION ONLY — LIMITED SEATS AVAILABLE

YOUR MEMORIES, BUT ELEVATED.
WARMEST REGARDS,
THE TOLL BRIDGE TEAM
PLEASE RSVP BY [DATE] TO SECURE YOUR PLACE



Email Marketing

1

Local Tasting Club Invitation

Reach past guests via booking records,
TripAdvisor, Google reviews

2

Exclusive Offer

Use code **SANDWICH_ORIGINS** for
complimentary Champagne

3

Newsletter Sign-Up

Encourage subscribers to stay connected with special events & menus

A New Chapter, Inspired by the Last.

Dear Neighbor,

For many years, The Toll Bridge (formerly the Smokehouse) has been a part of everyday life here in Sandwich — a place where many of you enjoyed relaxed meals, familiar flavours, and good company. As we've grown into a more elevated dining space, one thing has always stayed the same: our commitment to serving our community with warmth, quality, and care. Recently, our Michelin-experienced team revisited the old menu — not to replace it, but to understand what made those dishes so loved. And from that inspiration came something special...

A Heritage Edit: familiar flavours, crafted with new techniques, seasonal ingredients, and the kind of attention to detail we've always wanted to bring you.



ways wanted to bring you.

A Local Favourite



A New Expression of the Same Comfort



A Personal Note From Our Chef

"A boshocid stine-sourit, our experiential hoolts madly offering romoniking ucils what our winen is but con a community ain tnd and sel-wnchievement that with you."



A Warm Invitation: The Local Tasting Club



Thank you for locals fundering with along with our locals
We continues to oreware a soilt of to enjoy ov arvilners and
mane, postied on the etioningan'inst ot had of irpta.

[Reserve a Seat at the Local Tasting Club →](#)

Thank you for being part of Sandwich, and part of our story.
We can't wait to welcome you back.

Warmly,
The Toll Bridge Team

Content Marketing

Guest Testimonials

Share experiences from Local Tasting Club and Taste the Heritage launch events

Visual Storytelling

High-quality photos and videos of revamped classics across website, Facebook, Instagram



Groups



Sandwich Town Kent

Private · 25K members · 90+ posts a day

The very best place in England to live. A town full of character's ❤️🍷🍷

Join



Sandwich in Kent

Public · 9.7K members · 60 posts a day

A group to promote activities in Sandwich and local towns and villages nearby, check out local pubs, restaurants and cafes, shops, live music events, entertainment, shows and...

Join



Sandwich Kent

Private · 12K members · 20+ posts a day

Sandwich is a historic town and civil parish on the River Stour it, south-east England. It has a population of 4,985 It was one of the Cinque Ports and still has many original...

Join

See all

Menu Evolution

From traditional favorites to refined heritage classics

1

BBQ Pulled Pork Bun with Slaw



Orchard Pork & Crackling



2

Sticky Ribs



The 48-Hour Short Rib



3

Loaded Fries



Potato & Truffle



Behind the Scenes

Discover the craft and passion behind each heritage-inspired creation





The Toll Bridge

399 posts

1,793 followers

273 following

Restaurant

Riverside brasserie in Sandwich. Serving the finest local produce and classic cocktails.

[7 Fisherman's Wharf, Sandwich, Kent](#)

[thetollbridge.co.uk](#)

Follow

Message

Contact



Events



The grill



Sunday Lun...



















Experience the Heritage

 **thetollbridge**
28 Nov 2025

Welcoming everyone to try our new dishes!
Taste the Heritage 🍷

1. Orchard Pork & Crackling
2. The 48-Hour Short Rib
3. Potato & Truffle

The Tollbridge welcomes you. See you soon!



15,140 likes

Boost post

Like

Comment

Share

Join Our Tasting Events

Intimate gatherings celebrating local flavors, refined technique, and the stories behind each dish

 **thetollbridge**

Posts About Photos Reels More ▼

 **thetollbridge**

Orchard Pork Orchard Pork & Crackling



thetollbridge Orchard Pork & Crackling

The 43-Hour Short Rib

Potato & Truffle

Like Boost post

Timeline

Project	Month 1	Month 2	Month 3
Targeted Marketing	Design direct mail invitation letters and email templates	Large-Scale Direct Mail Outreach Send premium product invitations.	Secondary Precision Email Campaign Target active customer groups.
Product Development	Develop the “Heritage-Inspired” Menu Transform classic dishes into refined, innovative signature dishes.	Launch "Local Flavor Tasting Club" Release the "Heritage Flavor Special Menu"	Adjust offerings based on customer feedback to boost sales
Content Creation	Shoot “Classic vs. Innovative” Dish Comparison Videos. Record chef interviews and cooking videos.	Shoot Tasting Event & Guest Feedback Videos Produce premium dish tasting footage.	Edit Short Videos Showcasing Customer Praise Update content on the official website.
Social media	Introduce the event on platforms such as Facebook and Instagram.	Take pictures of this event and share them on social media to enhance social proof and emotional connection.	Pay close attention to the trends in comments and discussions. And adjust the activities based on the customers' comments



Success Metrics



Thank you